

Let's turn to the last assumption that the free will defense requires: the assumption that free will is a great good.

Free will is a
great good.

Even God could not
have given us free
will while ensuring
that we never used
that free will to
bring about evil.

We have free
will.

Many people think that it is; many think that life would not be worth living, or at least would be considerably worse, if we did not have free will.

Here's one way to call that assumption into question:

It is very important that we **feel** as though we have free will. Life would not be worth living if I did not feel as though my decisions were up to me. But it does not matter to the value of my life whether I really have free will; I would be just as well off if I were convinced that I had free will, but really didn't.



replies to
Libet

A large, solid red circle is centered on a white background. Inside the circle, the text "the Libet experiments" is written in a white, sans-serif font, centered both horizontally and vertically.

the Libet
experiments



is free will
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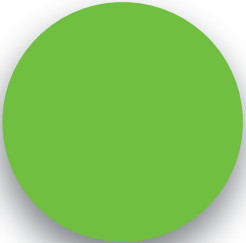
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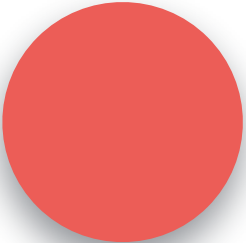


In ancient times, philosophers worried about the challenge to free will from fate. After

determinism. Our topic today is much more recent challenge to free

will prosper by contemporary neuroscience.

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